VIT BHOPAL

DIGITAL LITERACY

Project Report

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INTRODUCTION –

The objective of this project was to step up as student digital ambassador of this university and explore the different areas such digital ethics, safety from online fraud, connecting to different platforms, making formal communication on the internet and making graphics designs and The objective of this project was to step up as the student digital ambassador of this promote digital literacy across my peers.

Throughout these 5 tasks I have learned to make creative designs, connect to different platforms, make quiz for my peers, drafts formal emails, do a case study on UPI frauds and make a checklist of do's and don'ts for my peers.

TASK-1 – Presentation

Overview-
For task 1, I have made an infographic to create an awareness for digital literacy across the campus. I have used canva to make a simple, eye catching 16:9 infographic that explores what is digital literacy, introduced some popular digital platforms and some safe internet practices.

Reflections-
Designing this infographic was a significant learning curve in visual communication. As a Computer Science student, I am used to technical documentation, but this task required me to think like a designer and an educator. I realized that simply "knowing" a topic isn't enough; as a Digital Ambassador, I must be able to translate that knowledge into a format that captures attention in a crowded digital space. By creating this resource, I feel better prepared to advocate for safer and more productive internet habits among my batchmates, ensuring we all contribute to a healthier digital ecosystem at VIT Bhopal.

TASK-2 – Portfolio

Overview-

For this task I created accounts in three different platforms ie. Github, Linkedin and Kaggle. On GitHub, I created a specialized "Profile README" repository named exactly after my username, which serves as a landing page for my technical work. This README explicitly details my Registration Number (25BCE10937), my branch in Computer Science and Engineering, and my specific goals of mastering Python and JavaScript. On LinkedIn, I updated my education section to reflect my first-year status and projected graduation in 2029, which helps in networking with the broader VIT Bhopal alumni community. Finally, I set up a Kaggle profile to document my interest in data-driven problem solving and to participate in global competitions that benchmark my skills against industry standards.

Reflection-

Establishing this portfolio was an eye-opening exercise in managing my "digital footprint". As a Student Digital Ambassador, I realized that my online presence is often the first point of contact for recruiters, professors, and peers. By organizing my GitHub to be more than just a code storage site, I learned how to document my learning journey "under the hood" and present complex technical information clearly to an outside audience. Updating my LinkedIn taught me the value of professional networking; it is not just about having a profile, but about being part of an academic ecosystem at VIT Bhopal where we can share resources and opportunities.

How I will use them in the next 4 years-

All of these 3 platforms are highly useful.
github- I will use this for hosting my codes, doing version controls, and explore other repos.
Linkedin- I will use this to connect with my peers, share my achievements.

Kaggle- I will use this for data science and machine learning.

TASK-3 – Platforms

What I used and what I built-

For this task, I utilized **Google Forms** and **HackerRank** to perform a dual-layered assessment of digital proficiency. As a Student Digital Ambassador, I designed a comprehensive Google Form quiz specifically for my batchmates at VIT Bhopal to evaluate their understanding of essential digital literacy topics, such as phishing detection, two-factor authentication (2FA), and secure data management. I then collected and analyzed the response data to identify common vulnerabilities within the student community. Simultaneously, I focused on my own technical growth by practicing and verifying my coding skills on HackerRank. I successfully earned the **Python (Basic)** and **Problem Solving (Basic)** certifications, which required me to solve complex algorithmic challenges under a timed environment. By combining a community-facing survey with a globally recognized technical benchmark, I was able to demonstrate leadership while proving my own competency in Python, a core language in my B.Tech Computer Science curriculum.

TASK-4 – Email Etiquette

The communication scenarios I practiced involved two distinct professional interactions: a high-stakes academic request and a career-focused inquiry. I drafted a formal email to a professor at **VIT Bhopal** requesting a deadline extension for a Laplace transform quiz due to health issues, and a second email inquiring about summer internship opportunities at a major tech firm. These scenarios required me to transition from informal messaging styles to a structured, professional tone. I practiced using clear, searchable subject lines that included my full name and registration number (**25BCE10937**) to ensure my correspondence was easily identified and prioritized by the recipient.

My key learning from this task was that digital communication is a direct reflection of my professional brand as a **Student Digital Ambassador**. I realized that a well-structured email with a concise "ask" and a respectful sign-off significantly increases the likelihood of a positive response from faculty or recruiters. Additionally, creating the social media checklist taught me that maintaining a clean "digital footprint" is a continuous process. I learned that as a representative of my university, I must balance personal expression with professional responsibility, ensuring that my online presence remains a career asset rather than a liability.

TASK-5 – Cybercrime Awareness

What surprised you and one habit you will change: What surprised me most during this research was how easily sophisticated technical security can be bypassed through simple social engineering. I was shocked to learn that many victims of the UPI QR code scam are actually tech-savvy students who understand how apps work but are caught off-guard by the psychological pressure and artificial urgency created by scammers. It was eye-opening to realize that the primary vulnerability in our digital financial system at **VIT Bhopal** is not a software bug or a weak password, but rather the human tendency to trust a "verified-looking" request when we are in a hurry.

As a direct result of this task, the one habit I will change is my approach to scanning QR codes and authorizing "Receive" requests. Moving forward, I will strictly follow the "PIN Rule": I will never enter my UPI PIN to receive money, regardless of how official the sender's account appears. Additionally, I have committed to verifying the identity of any buyer or seller through a secondary channel before initiating any digital transaction. As a **Student Digital Ambassador**, I now recognize that being digitally literate means maintaining a healthy level of skepticism and pausing to read every transaction screen carefully before hitting "Confirm".

CONCLUSION-

Completing this project was a great journey, I learned a lot realised many thing and I will definitely go further in this topic to explore more areas of digital literacy.

By moving through each task—from designing educational infographics in Canva to establishing a globally verifiable portfolio on **GitHub** and **Kaggle**—I have shifted my identity from a passive student to an active **Student Digital Ambassador**. I learned that a professional "digital footprint" is a living asset that requires constant curation and that my ability to communicate clearly via email is as critical as my ability to write clean code in Python or JavaScript.

I have developed a habit of skepticism toward unsolicited digital requests and a commitment to professional networking that will serve as the foundation for my four-year B.Tech journey. This project has equipped me with the confidence to lead by example, ensuring that I remain a responsible, literate, and high-achieving participant in the modern digital economy.

REFERENCES –

Technical platforms –

1. **GitHub:**. (github.com)
2. **LinkedIn:** (linkedin.com)
3. **Kaggle:** (kaggle.com)
4. **HackerRank:** (hackerrank.com)

Content creation –

1. **Canva**
2. **Google forms**